

expect a privileged lifestyle, but no one was entirely safe under Stalin's tyranny. Initially, he was allowed to keep his passport and he made visits to Europe and even another tour of the US in 1938. However, he was then asked to hand in the passport, ostensibly for routine administrative purposes, and it was never returned, meaning that he was trapped in his homeland.

Prokofiev continued to produce major works, including the music for Sergei Eisenstein's celebrated film *Alexander Nevsky* (1938), but he was also obliged to create hollow pieces extolling the Soviet regime—for example, a cantata celebrating Stalin's 60th birthday (1939). During World War II he was evacuated from Moscow to keep him out of danger and was awarded the title of Honored Artist of the Soviet Union. However, in 1948, along with other composers, he was accused of showing decadent Western influence in his music and had to sign a public apology to "Dear Comrade Stalin." Soon afterward his wife Lina (whom he had abandoned for a younger woman) was arrested for alleged espionage and spent eight years in Siberian labor camps.

Several of Prokofiev's works were officially blacklisted, but he was soon rehabilitated, and in 1951 he won the last of his six Stalin Prizes. However, by this time—following a bad fall and a stroke—the composer was seriously ill.

Prokofiev died in Moscow on March 5, 1953—the same day as Stalin. Because of this coincidence, his death passed almost unremarked. It is said that every florist in Moscow was ordered to use their entire stock for Stalin's funeral, Prokofiev's mourners consequently had to make do with paper flowers.